

A BODY OF WORK BY

LUIZA *JESUS DO PRADO*

TRANSDISCIPLINARY ARTIST · RESEARCHER · SCIENTIST

BIO · CONTACT

SELECTED WORKS



BIO

LIGHT DESCRIBES ME, REVEALS YOU.

Luiza Jesus do Prado, who also works as MAVRA (and earlier as Hifa Cybe), is an artist, researcher and technologist. She was born in 1988 on the rural outskirts of Guaratinguetá, São Paulo, and trained in biomedical science and photography. Her work sits between art, science and technology.

Memory is at the centre of her research, and with it mental health: trauma, death, environmental collapse, gender, sexuality, and the roots of pain and violence. She looks at how ideas of madness have been built and repeated over time, and argues for an approach to mental health that takes emotional, spiritual and political life into account.

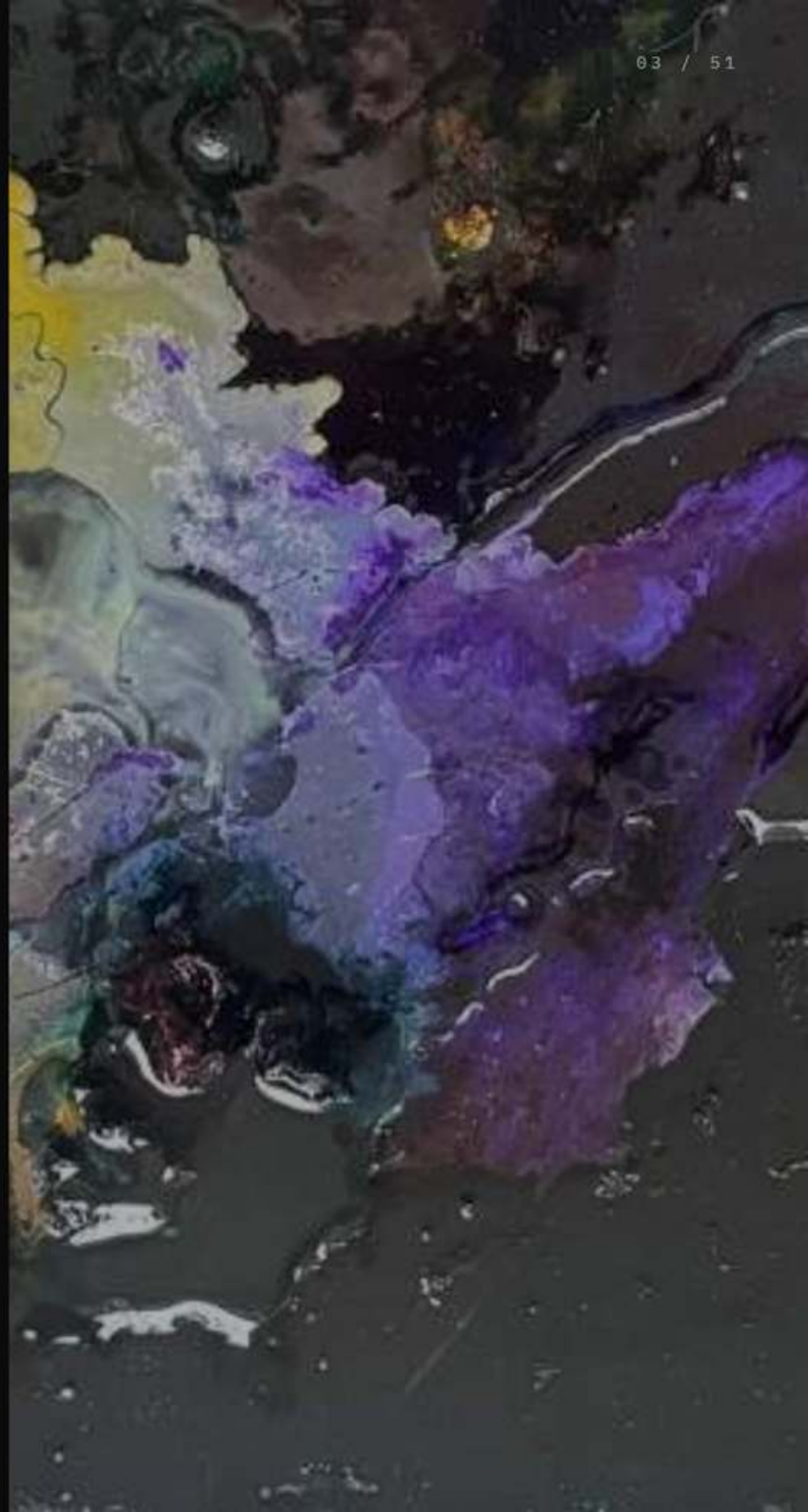
Since 2010 she has developed methods for reprocessing trauma through photography and sound. More recently the research has moved into physical and chemical processes, and into how these treatments could reach public healthcare.

She works with expanded photography, sound and the body. Her performances draw on Butoh, physical theatre, contemporary dance, chain suspension and Shibari. She also makes objects, video, texts, paintings and sculpture, and works with food, gas, scent and immersive technology.

Her work has been shown at Pacific Standard Time: LA/LA, the Biennale Internationale Casablanca, the Changjiang International Photo & Video Biennale and Off Biennale Cairo. It is held in the collections of MAC Bogotá, Enter Art Foundation (Berlin), the Municipal Museum of Cusco, Building Bridges Exchange Foundation (Los Angeles) and Museo Arte Al Límite (Chile). Her video performance Symbiogenesis received the First Honorable Mention of the Pangue Video Performance Award (Chile, 2026), and The Weight of Feeling was an Official Selection of MORPH Film Festival.

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RESEARCH LINES

01	DECOLONIZATION AND MENTAL HEALTH	Image reprocessing · Trauma · Memory · Madness · Spirituality · History of psychiatry · Public healthcare
02	ART, SCIENCE AND COGNITIVE TECHNOLOGIES	Memory · Neuroscience · AI · Machine learning · Psychobiology · Simulated psychedelia
03	THE BODY AS TECHNOLOGY, RITUAL AND PSYCHOSOMATIC DEVICE	Ritual · Psychosoma · Butoh · Trance
04	EROTICISM, DISSIDENCE AND THE ECONOMY OF THE BODY	Sexuality and Gender · Economy of desire · Decolonization of the body
05	PROSTHETICS, ROBOTICS AND THE POST-HUMAN BODY	Post-humanism · Robotics · Prosthetics · Wearables · Body-instrument · Sound and light objects



SELECTED *PROJECTS*

CURRENT PRACTICE · THIRTEEN RESEARCH PLATFORMS

01	CAMARA OBSCURA	P. 06
02	ECOLOGIES OF PERCEPTION	P. 10
03	WHAT IS MADNESS?	P. 13
04	GARDEN OF DREAMS AND NIGHTMARES	P. 16
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PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 01 · 2023

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2023



CAMARA OBSCURA

PHOTOGRAPHY, NOISE, PHYSICS AND NEUROSCIENCE: CAN A PHOTOGRAPH BRING A MEMORY BACK, AND HOW WOULD WE READ IT?

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

PHOTOGRAPHY, NOISE, PHYSICS, SEMIOTICS, NEUROSCIENCE AND PSYCHOLOGY, BROUGHT TOGETHER TO ASK WHETHER IMAGES CAN HELP MEMORIES RETURN.

Images already have a place in therapy. EMDR and psychodrama use them to work through trauma, and they are used with memory loss in cognitive and neurological conditions, including Alzheimer's disease. The project tests desensitization through photographs and through installations built around remembering.

KEYWORDS

Memory · Trauma · Image · Noise · Perception · Therapeutic technologies

RESEARCH LINE

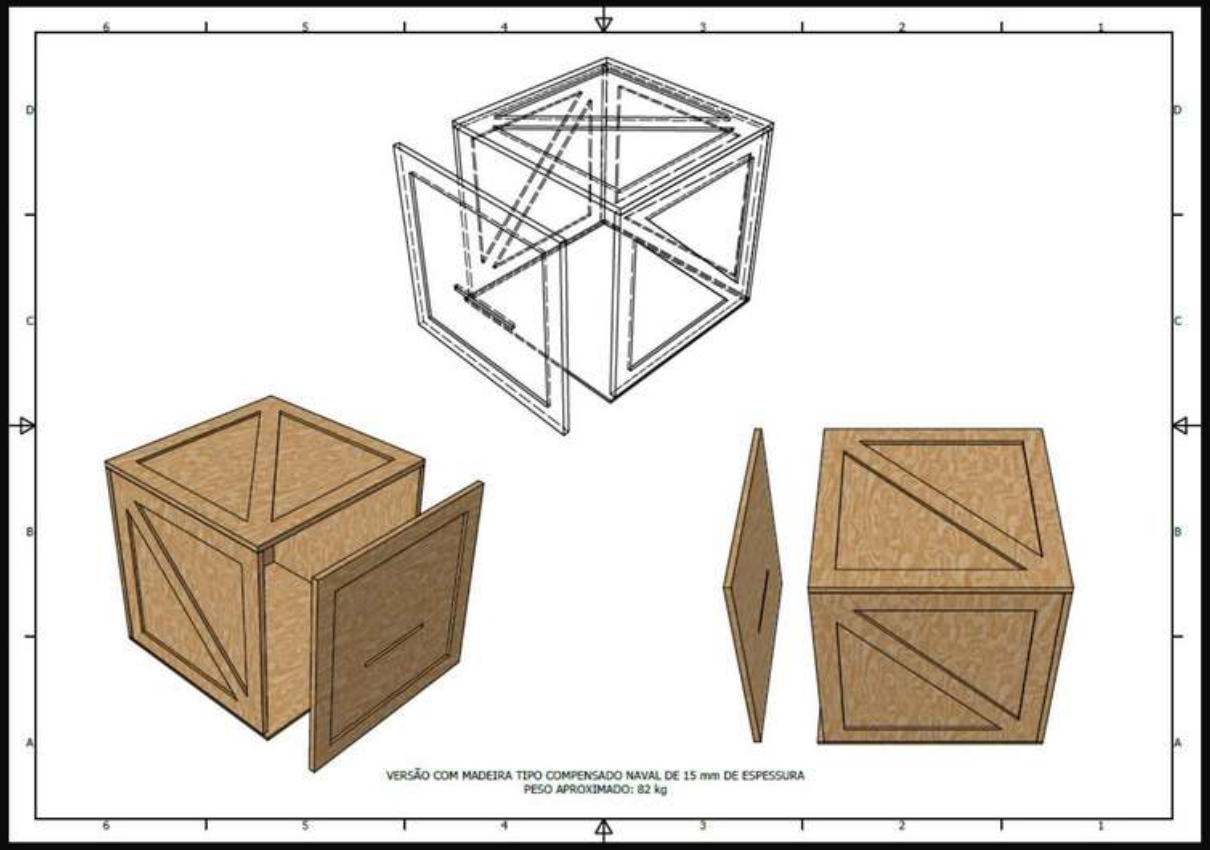
Semiotics · Machine learning · Neuroscience · Biophysics · Photography · Wave theory

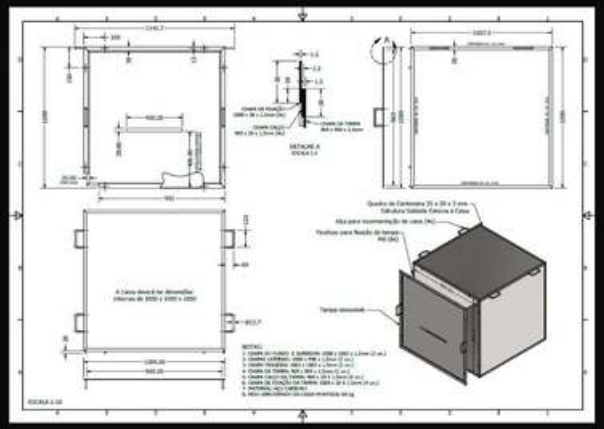
PRACTICES

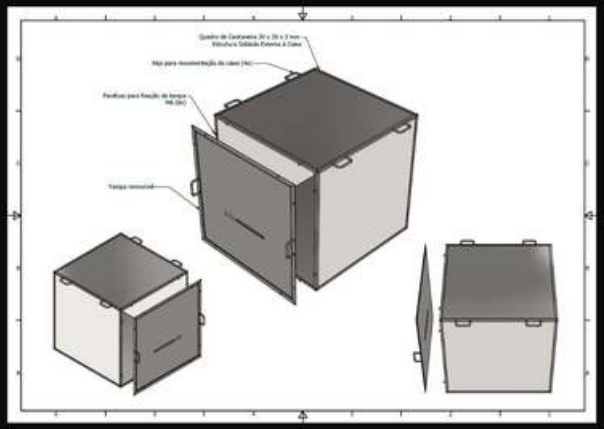
Object · Photography · New media · Technical drawing · Noise

CAMARA OBSCURA · DOCUMENTATION

03 IMAGES







CAMARA OBSCURA · DOCUMENTATION

04 IMAGES









LUIZA JESUS DO PRADO

PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 02 - 2022

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2022

ECOLOGIES OF PERCEPTION

THE VISUAL, SENSORY AND THERAPEUTIC SIDES
OF NON-ORDINARY STATES OF CONSCIOUSNESS.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

LIGHT, SOUND, SMELL AND SPACE AS TOOLS THAT SHAPE PERCEPTION AND NEUROPLASTICITY.

Ecologies of Perception looks at the visual, sensory and therapeutic sides of non-ordinary states of consciousness. In these states, activity at serotonin 5-HT2A receptors changes how things are seen, heard and felt, sometimes producing synesthesia, distorted sound and a loss of the sense of self.

The research asks how light, sound, smell and space can shape perception and neuroplasticity. Instead of reproducing psychedelic imagery, the project builds controlled environments that turn perceptual states into things you can see, hear, smell and touch.

It started in 2022 as a self-experiment. Prado, an autistic and gifted artist, kept diaries in Portuguese, Spanish and English recording her responses to altered states of consciousness, alongside paintings and process videos.

The work so far includes generative visual studies; Artificial Ghosts, a sound piece made with Celio Barros; motion by Guilherme Todorov and mapping by VJ Spetto; installations with projection, texture, glycerin mist and lavender; and Holy Supper, a molecular-gastronomy performance drawing on the history and symbols of sacred plants and rituals. Together they propose a calm, welcoming setting for spiritual, creative and therapeutic exploration.

KEYWORDS

Altered States · Synesthesia · Neuroplasticity · Multisensory Immersion · Mental Health

RESEARCH LINE

Neuroscience · Perception · Default Mode Network · Sensory Psychology · Decolonial Mental Health

PRACTICES

Multisensory Installation · Painting · Generative Film · Sound · Scent · Light · Video Mapping · Molecular Gastronomy · Performance

ECOLOGIES OF PERCEPTION · DOCUMENTATION

06 IMAGES













PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 03 · 2023

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2023

WHAT IS MADNESS?

FOUR WORKS ON MENTAL HEALTH AND THE WORLD THAT SHAPES IT, FED BY REAL DATA FROM EVERY PLACE.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

ANYONE CAN LOSE THEIR MIND. SANITY IS ALSO A PLACE.

What Is Madness? asks what madness and sanity are, if anyone can break under the right conditions. In the first year of the pandemic, anxiety and depression rose by 25% worldwide (WHO, 2022). Wars, hunger, heat and debt push the same way; care, cooperation and hope push back.

The core concept is allostatic load, the wear a body carries from repeated adaptation to stress (McEwen and Stellar, 1993), applied to places. Each social and environmental factor becomes a mediator of stress or care, with its own colour and pitch. The data come from open sources such as USGS, GDACS, GDELT, HDX HAPI (UN OCHA), Open-Meteo and the World Bank.

FOUR WORKS

ALLOSTATIC LOAD

An online lab where 17 places and the whole world become images and sound, refreshed every hour from real data.

OBSERVATORY

Mental health quoted like money, next to the S&P 500, the Ibovespa and the VIX.

MANDALA OF THE UNCONSCIOUS

A mandala drawn from the visitor's own searches. Nothing leaves the browser.

SIRENE

A 2.70 m column of light for galleries, with a mandala of light on the floor and a continuous chord.

KEYWORDS

Allostatic Load · Madness and Sanity · Collective Distress · Care · Open Data

RESEARCH LINE

Decolonization and Mental Health · Psychobiology · Anti-asylum Movement · Art, Science and Cognitive Technologies

PRACTICES

Generative Image · Sound · Web · Light and Sound Object · Projection Mapping · Street Intervention

WHAT IS MADNESS? · DOCUMENTATION

05 IMAGES



SIRENE · 3D SIMULATION



ALLOSTATIC LOAD · THE LAB

OBSERVATORY · THE FLOOR



MANDALA · THE WHOLE WORLD



MAPPING · FIRST VIDEO STUDY

PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 04 · 2024

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2024

GARDEN OF DREAMS *AND NIGHTMARES*

SITUATED BETWEEN THE LOOM AND THE HARVEST. PAINTINGS IN LATEX AND ENCAUSTIC BUILT UP UNTIL THEY FEEL LIKE SKIN.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

MEMORY AS SYMBOLIC TERRITORY, SOMEWHERE BETWEEN WEAVING AND GATHERING.

The Garden of Dreams and Nightmares, Situated Between the Loom and the Harvest is part of ongoing research on memory as symbolic territory, somewhere between weaving and gathering. It draws on Yanomami and Andean cosmologies, in which dreaming is shared knowledge.

The loom stands for the threads between worlds, gestures and experiences. The harvest is what comes back to the body and the community. The garden is where memory takes root and changes.

The paintings are built up in layers of latex and encaustic until they feel like skin. Gesture from the performances stays in the surface as trace, texture and temperature.

Neuroscience describes dreaming as the brain consolidating memory and reorganizing synapses. Here the brain is a loom, weaving feelings and past experience into stories where truth, delusion and ancestry meet.

KEYWORDS

Dreams · Loom · Harvest · Skin · Ancestry · Symbolic Memory

RESEARCH LINE

Symbolic Memory · Imagination · Ancestry · Indigenous Cosmologies

PRACTICES

Expanded Painting · Sculpture · Installation · Object

GARDEN OF DREAMS AND NIGHTMARES · DOCUMENTATION

04 IMAGES









RESEARCH · PERFORMANCE
/ 05 · 2023

INSTALLATION
SINCE 2023



BUTOH CAIPIRA

RURAL BODIES OF THE BRAZILIAN INTERIOR
THAT DANCE SYNCRETISM AND POPULAR MEMORY.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

A PEASANT BUTOH: A BODY SHAPED BY PLACE, COLLECTIVE MEMORY AND RELIGIOUS SYNCRETISM.

Butoh Caipira moves Butoh into the landscape of rural Brazil, especially the valleys of the Paraíba do Sul and Paraitinga rivers. The idea is a peasant Butoh: a body shaped by place, collective memory, religious syncretism and local beliefs about land and water.

Butoh began in post-war Japan as a way of moving that stays close to time, death, decay and presence. In the Brazilian interior, where farming and river communities live with mixed and ancestral religious practices, it takes on another shape. Here soil is territory, food, sacred matter and danger at once.

KEYWORDS

Rural Brazil · Earth · Rivers · Ancestry · Death · Transformation

RESEARCH LINE

Somatic and Transgenerational Memory · Rural Cosmologies · Spiritualities of the Earth · Otherness · Rural Dissent · Psychogeography · Biology

PRACTICES

Performance · Butoh · Installations · Sculptures · Objects

BUTOH CAIPIRA · DOCUMENTATION

04 IMAGES









PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 06 · 2026

PERFORMANCE · SCULPTURE
FILM · 2026



THE WEIGHT OF FEELING

PAIN, PERCEPTION AND INNER STATES, HELD BY MEDUSA, A HYBRID DEVICE OF AERIAL CHAINS AND SHIBARI. OFFICIAL SELECTION, MORPH FILM FESTIVAL.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

PAIN, PERCEPTION AND THE WAY INNER STATES BECOME MATTER, HELD IN ROPE AND STEEL.

The Weight of Feeling looks at pain, perception and the way inner states become matter. It is built around MEDUSA, a hybrid device of aerial chains and shibari: the structure of a two-chain aerial rig with a shibari ring at its centre, and optional side rings for lateral ties. Rope brings flexibility, steel brings weight. Together they compress, restrain and leave marks on the body.

The work starts from lived experience. Some neurological and psychological conditions do not process pain, emotion or affect in socially standard ways. Pain, love, longing and absence are treated as universal, yet how they are felt, recognised and expressed varies widely. For some bodies these states are not immediately legible and need a material anchor to become perceptible. Binding the body turns something abstract into something visible. Pain here is not suffering but inscription.

The work also asks who decides what a “normal” way of feeling is. Medical, cultural and colonial frameworks have built hierarchies of perception, and bodies that feel differently are often labelled pathological. From a decolonial perspective, if emotions are culturally mediated, the ways bodies express them are plural and situated.

Gender runs through the same questions. Studies report higher rates of gender diversity among autistic people, and for many, gender is less an intuitive category than a structure imposed from outside. Recognising oneself as trans or gender-nonconforming can bring exposure, tension and a kind of social pain. Under rope and chain, the body shows identity being negotiated between inner perception and outside pressure: a place where affect is negotiated, materialised and remembered.

KEYWORDS

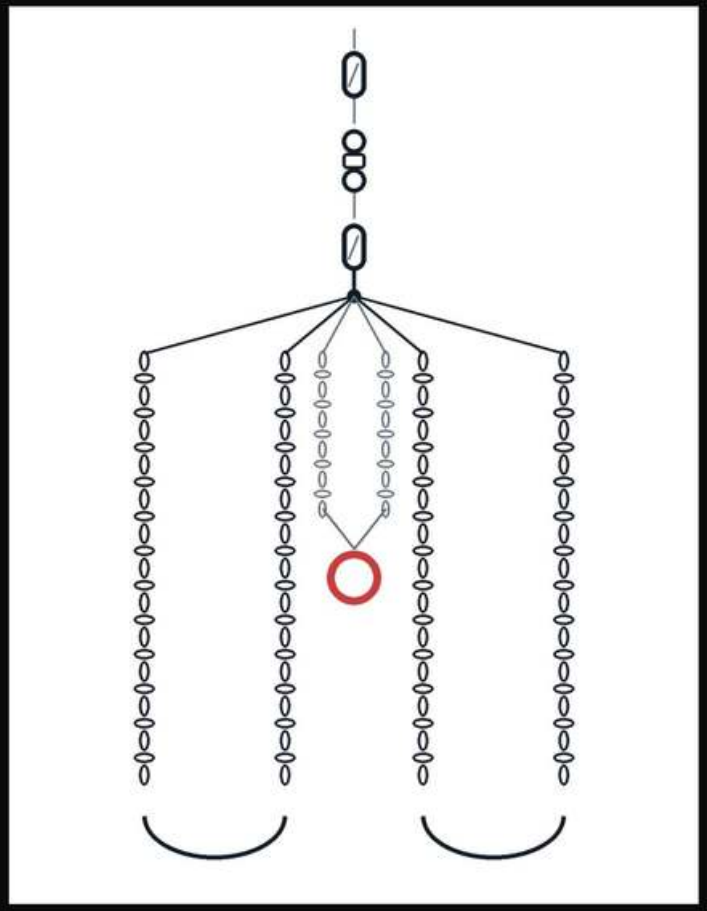
Pain · Perception · Agender · Autism · Mental Health · Memory

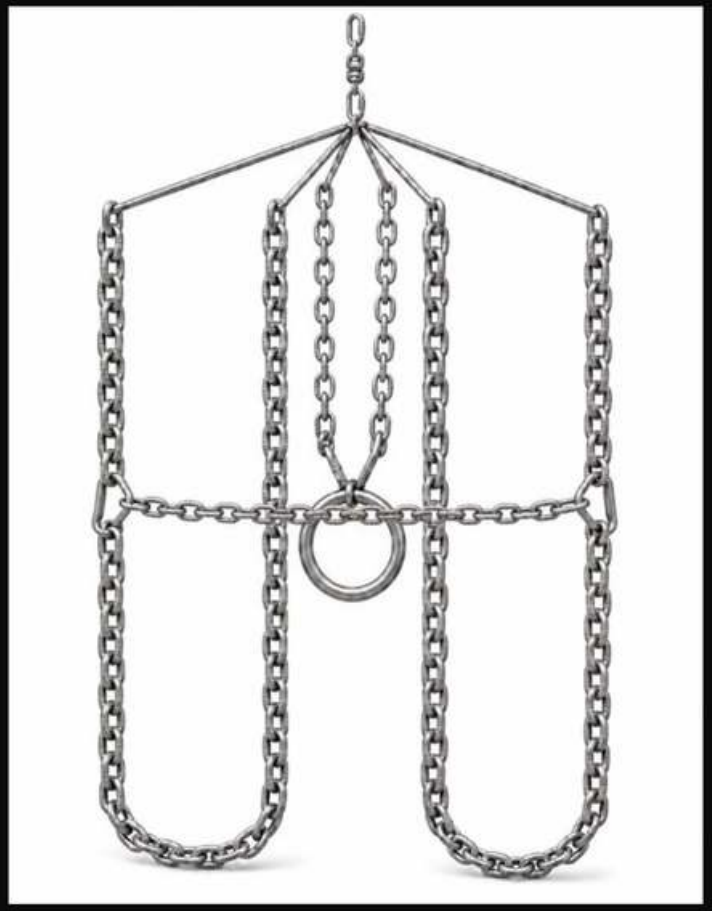
RESEARCH LINE

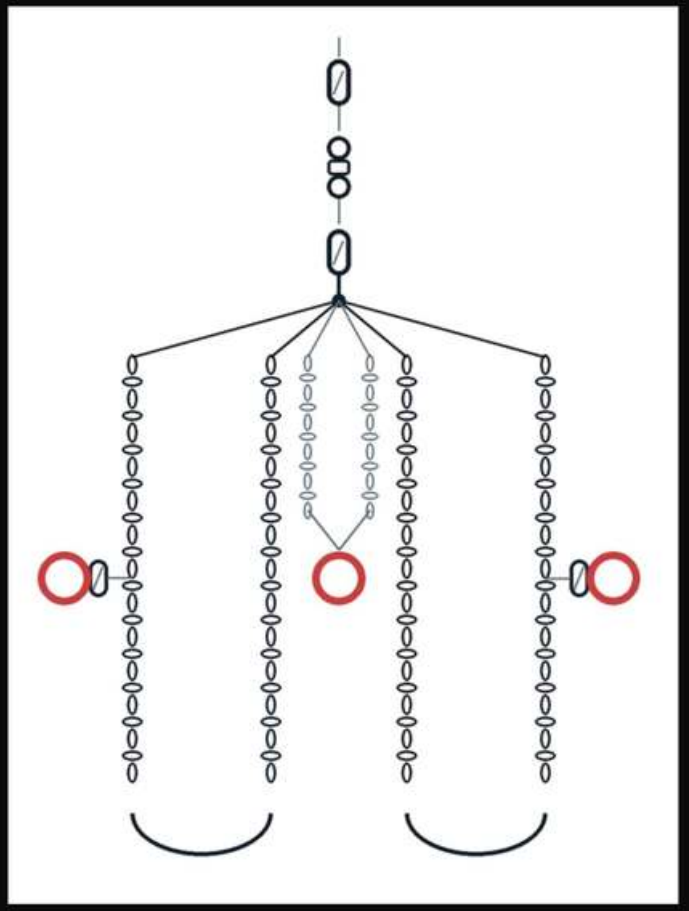
Body Arts · Neurodiversity · Decolonial Mental Health

PRACTICES

Performance · Shibari · Aerial Chains · Sculpture · Moving Image







PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 07 · 2026

ACTIVE PROJECT
2026

APOPHENIA *AND PAREIDOLIA*

A FACE IN A CLOUD, A FIGURE IN A STAIN:
PERCEPTION AS AN ACT OF INVENTION.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

FINDING PATTERNS WHERE THERE ARE NONE: THE EYE DOES NOT SIMPLY RECEIVE THE WORLD, IT INVENTS IT.

Apophenia and Pareidolia looks at our habit of finding patterns where there are none. Pareidolia is its most familiar form: a face in a cloud, a figure in a stain.

The work treats perception as something creative. The eye does not simply receive the world, it invents it. In textures, stains and organic shapes the mind keeps looking for figures, an old survival reflex that turns uncertainty into images.

Moving between the botanical and the artificial, the pieces sit at the point where the real starts to dissolve and the imagined takes shape, and ask the viewer to look at how they look.

KEYWORDS

Apophenia · Pareidolia · Perception · Noise · Randomness · Imagination

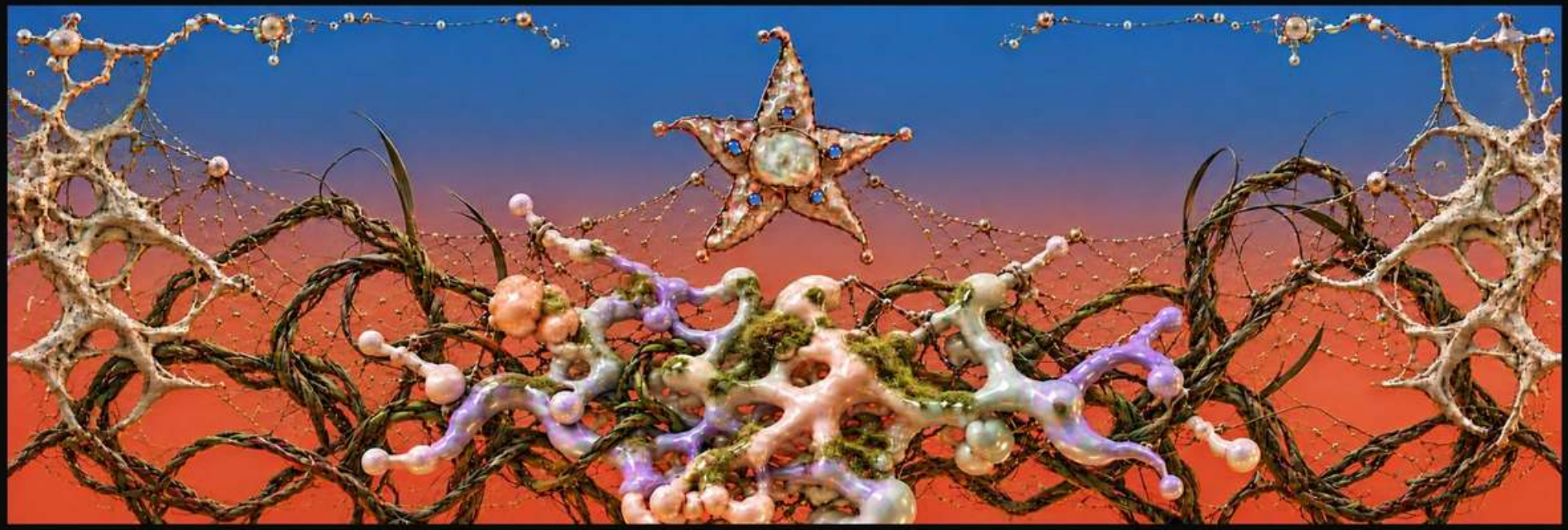
RESEARCH LINE

Perception · Cognition · Psychology of Vision

PRACTICES

Sculptural Objects · Digital Image · Text





PERFORMANCE
/ 08 · 2012

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2012

COLONIZED SEXUALITY

CHRISTIAN, PATRIARCHAL AND EUROCENTRIC
NORMS THAT TURN DESIRE INTO DISCIPLINE.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

A BODY CROSSED BY RULES THAT ARE NOT ITS OWN.

Colonized sexuality is a body crossed by rules that are not its own. Imposed by Christian, patriarchal and Eurocentric thinking, they turn desire into discipline, skin into a border and gender into a cell.

Colonizing sexuality cuts pleasure off from spirit, affection from land and the body from its history. It erases cosmologies in which sex was ritual, connection, passage and life force. Decolonizing it means recovering those links, not only resisting.

KEYWORDS

Desire · Coloniality · Gender · Spirituality · Decolonization

RESEARCH LINE

Anthropology · Sexuality and Gender

PRACTICES

Video Performance · Video Art · Installations · Photography · Poems

COLONIZED SEXUALITY · DOCUMENTATION

03 IMAGES







PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 09 · 2010

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2010



DIARY OF MEMORIES *I DO NOT HAVE*

SELF-PORTRAITS AS CATHARSIS, LATER USED WITH PSYCHODRAMA AND EMDR.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

PHOTOGRAPHY, NOISE AND PERFORMANCE USED TO DESENSITIZE TRAUMATIC MEMORIES.

This project uses photography, noise and performance to desensitize traumatic memories of sexual abuse. It draws on EMDR and psychodrama, with the artist's own body and history as the material.

It began in 2010 with photography and self-portraits as a form of catharsis, a way to show situations, traumas, depression and phobias that could not yet be put into words.

At the time Prado found herself drawn to the work of Francesca Woodman and Diane Arbus. The self-portraits later became the basis for treatment using Jacob Levy Moreno's psychodrama and Francine Shapiro's EMDR.

KEYWORDS

Trauma · Self-portrait · Sexual Abuse · Catharsis · Reprocessing

RESEARCH LINE

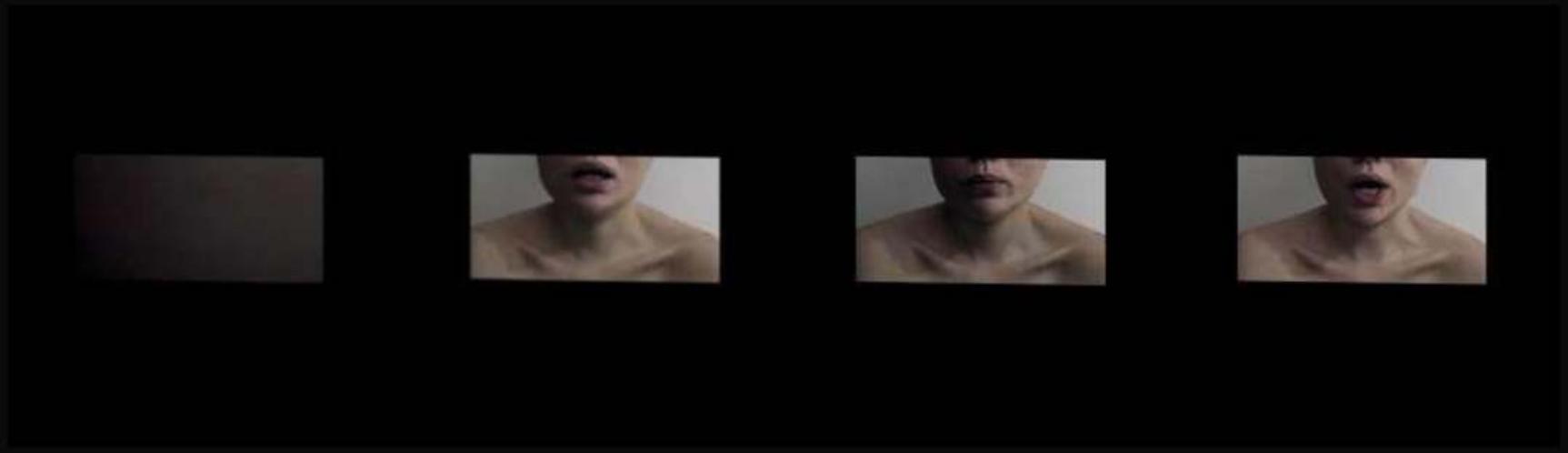
Psychology · Psychiatry · EMDR · Psychodrama

PRACTICES

Video Performance · Photography · Video Art · Poem

DIARY OF MEMORIES I DO NOT HAVE · DOCUMENTATION

04 IMAGES









PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 10 · 2022

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2022



TOPOGRAPHIES OF VIOLENCE

THE QUEER AND DISSIDENT BODY AS A PLACE WRITTEN OVER BY POWER, AND AS A PLACE THAT WRITES BACK.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

A MAP MARKED BY REPEATED STRUCTURAL VIOLENCE, AND THE BODIES THAT RESIST IT.

The queer and dissident body, whether racialized, displaced or pathologized, is written over by power again and again, and it is also where resistance gets written back. By living outside cis-heteronormativity, outside capitalist productivity and outside the binary thinking of Western science, it pushes against the structures built to control it.

KEYWORDS

Queer Body · Structural Violence · Territory · Dissidence · Control

RESEARCH LINE

Sexuality and Gender

PRACTICES

Performance · Video Art · Video Performance · Object · Installation · Photography

TOPOGRAPHIES OF VIOLENCE · DOCUMENTATION

05 IMAGES











PRACTICE RESEARCH
/ 11 · 2021

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2021



DISCOURSES OF *NECROPOLITICS*

WHICH LIVES COUNT AS GRIEVABLE, VISIBLE OR VALUABLE?

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

HOW DEATH, DISPOSABILITY AND SYSTEMIC VIOLENCE BECOME NORMAL IN EVERYDAY LIFE.

Discourses of Necropolitics looks at how death, disposability and systemic violence become normal, aesthetic and operational in everyday life.

Drawing on Achille Mbembe's concept of necropolitics, the project examines how states, institutions and media decide which lives count as grievable, visible or valuable, through performance, video, installation, objects and photography.

KEYWORDS

Death · State Violence · Disposability · Power · Public Memory

RESEARCH LINE

Sociopolitics · Public Memory · Necropolitics

PRACTICES

Performance · Video Performance · Installation · Object · Photography

DISCOURSES OF NECROPOLITICS · DOCUMENTATION

03 IMAGES

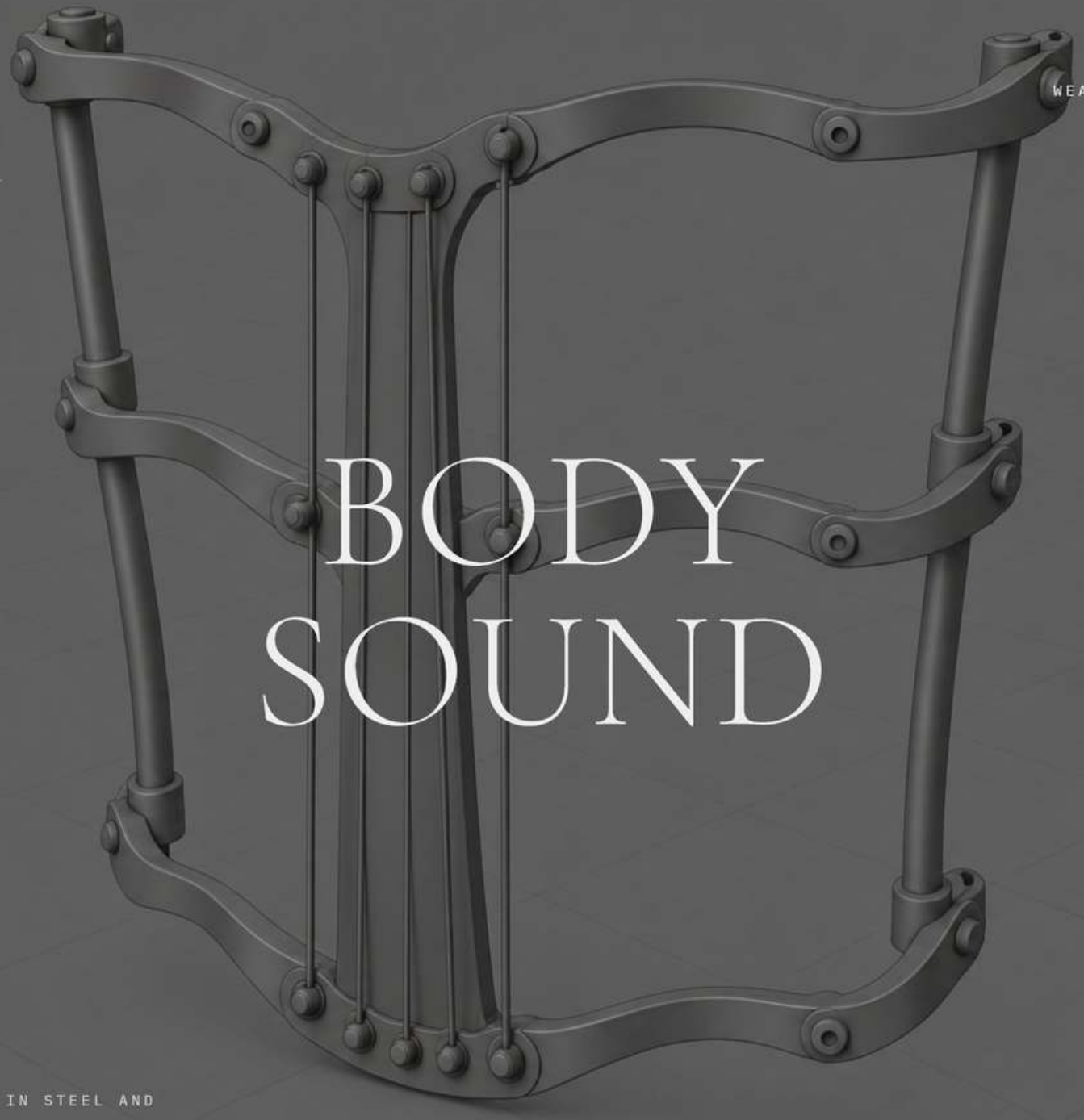






PRACTICE RESEARCH · PERFORMANCE
/ 12 · 2026

WEARABLE INSTRUMENTS · BODY
PIANO · CELLO · 2026



BODY SOUND

TWO WEARABLE INSTRUMENTS IN STEEL AND LEATHER, PLAYED BY THE AUDIENCE ON THE PERFORMER'S BODY.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

TWO WEARABLE INSTRUMENTS, PLAYED BY THE AUDIENCE ON THE PERFORMER'S BODY.

Body Sound is a research project on wearable sound devices. Each device is a separate piece worn by the performer, built on a corset of leather and steel stays that carries the load on the torso and leaves elbows and knees free. The sound comes from the metal worn on the body: stays, plates, blades, springs, rods and strings.

There are two instruments, presented separately. In the Body-Piano the performer lies on a padded platform and the audience presses keys fixed to her body; each key moves a felt hammer that strikes the metal underneath. In the Body-Cello she stands, and the audience plays strings mounted on her back, arm and shin with bows or fingers.

Playing requires no musical training. The vibration of each key and string passes through the structure into the performer's body, and her breathing, posture and shifts of weight change the tension of the parts and therefore the sound.

The project currently consists of 3D models, technical drawings and leather patterns. The devices will be fabricated and tested on the body during an artist residency.

KEYWORDS

Body-instrument · Prepared piano · Vibration · Wearable object · Audience participation

RESEARCH LINE

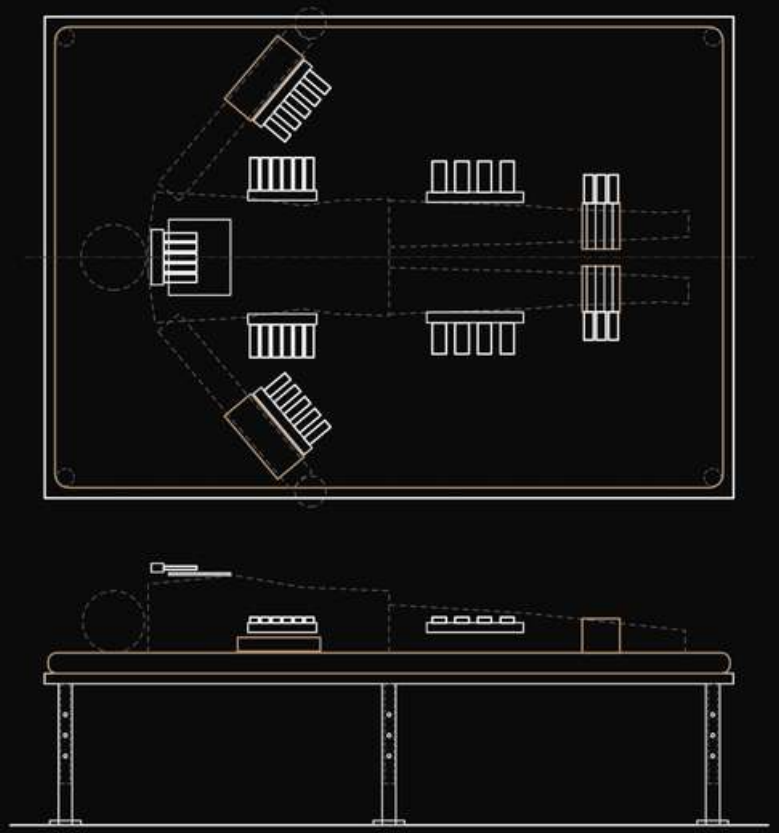
Prosthetics, Robotics and the Post-Human Body · Somatic Practices · Phenomenology of the Body · Experimental Music

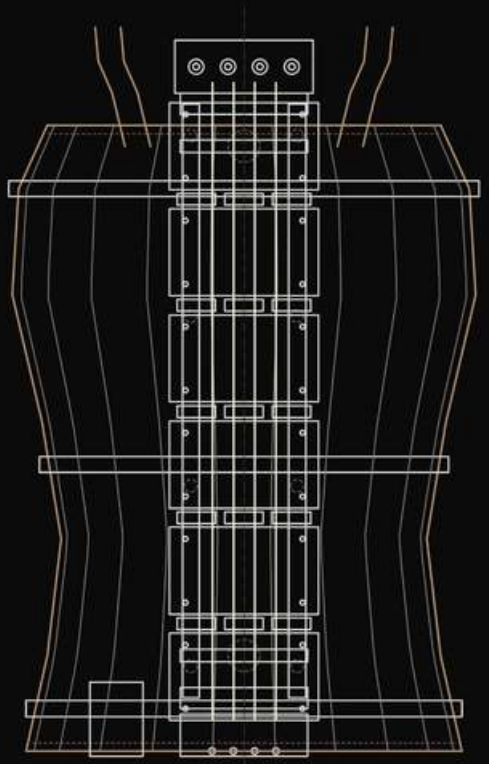
PRACTICES

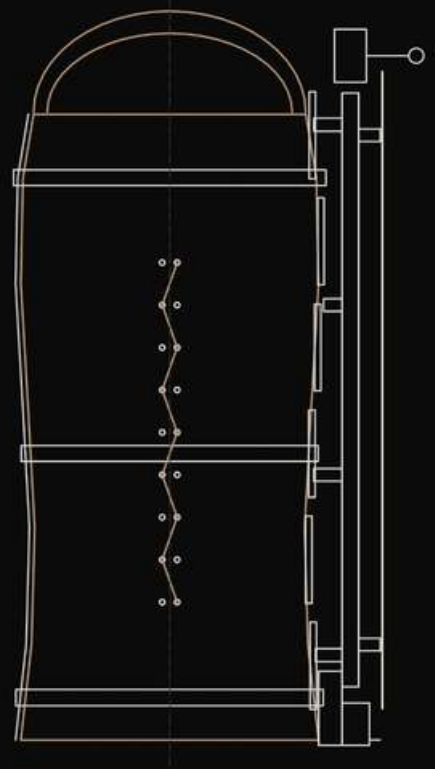
Performance · Wearable Object · Sound · Instrument Building

BODY SOUND · TECHNICAL DRAWINGS

03 IMAGES

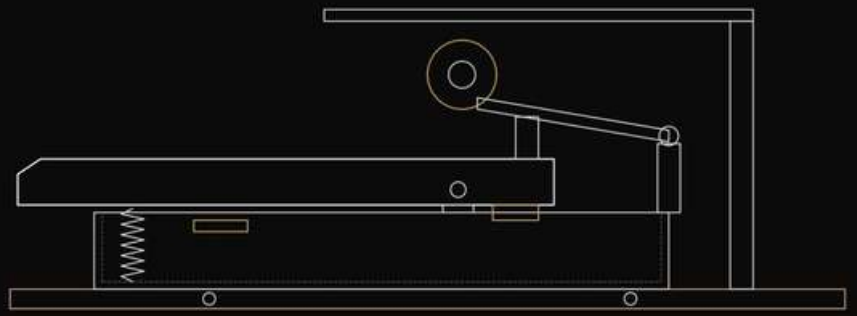






BODY-PIANO · PLAN AND SIDE VIEW

BODY-CELLO · BACK AND SIDE · KEY MECHANISM, SECTION



ARCHIVE · PERFORMANCE
/ 13 · 2023

ACTIVE PROJECT
SINCE 2023



APPROPRIATION

PROSTITUTION, EROTICISM, FETISH AND BDSM,
AND THEIR SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC WEIGHT.

ORIGINAL FILES ↗

STATEMENT

HOW SEXUALITY IS SHOWN IN ART AND ENTERTAINMENT, AND THE POWER, EXCLUSION AND RESISTANCE IT REVEALS.

Appropriation looks at how sexuality is shown in art and entertainment, and at the power, exclusion and resistance this reveals. It works with the imagery of prostitution, eroticism, fetish and BDSM, and with their social and economic weight.

Sex work, from prostitution and live-streaming to striptease, pole dance, burlesque, BDSM and porn, is shaped by power, appropriation and subversion. The bodies that perform desire are both objects and subjects in this economy. They show capitalist exploitation, and also room for autonomy and resistance.

KEYWORDS

Desire · Body · Power · Eroticism · Labor · Resistance

RESEARCH LINE

Decolonization of the Body · Sexuality and Gender · Cultural and Somatic Memory · Body Arts · New Technologies · Technology and Economics of the Body

PRACTICES

Performance · Video Performance · Object · Photography · Installation · Video Art · Shibari · Pole Dance · Exotic Dance · Heels

APPROPRIATION · DOCUMENTATION

04 IMAGES







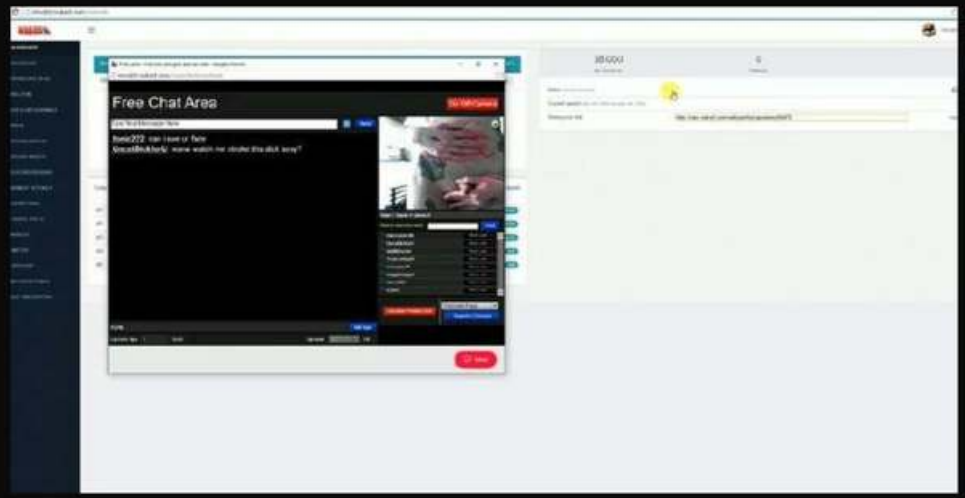


APPROPRIATION · DOCUMENTATION

03 IMAGES













BODY ARTS *& PERFORMANCES*

Butoh, physical theatre, chain suspension and Shibari. The body works as an archive: weight, breath and suspension carry memory.

SELECTED WORKS
AS MAVRA

MAVRA PORTFOLIO ↗

INSTAGRAM ↗



PHOTOGRAPHY *& MIXED MEDIA*

Expanded photography, urban exploration and photographic reprocessing. Images are taken apart, printed, burnt and rebuilt as a way of working through memory.

SELECTED WORKS
SINCE 2010

INSTAGRAM ↗







CINEMA

FILM AND
MOVING IMAGE

Short films and video works made in ruins, abandoned trains and dark rooms, where the body tries to be born again.

MUBI ↗ IMDB ↗



SOUND

Noise, field recording and voice, released as Luiza Jesus do Prado and earlier as Hifa Cybe. Sound is also a tool in the research on memory and perception.

ALBUMS, EPS
AND COLLABORATIONS

WEBSITE ↗


THANK
YOU